

Someone on the phone – An emergency – Teacher's pack

English in my home – Someone on the phone

Unit 2c – An emergency



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Introduction

This resource has been produced in two different formats:

- a self-access resource for learners with online activities
- this teacher's pack, including teacher's notes and worksheets to download

Overview

This resource, ***Someone on the phone – An emergency***, is part of Unit 2 of *English in my home*, which aims to give ESOL learners the confidence and the language to deal with situations they may encounter in their homes.

There are three units of ***English in my home***:

Unit 1 Someone at the door aims to give learners confidence and equip them with the language necessary to deal with situations where unexpected callers (e.g. an electricity meter reader) arrive at the door.

Unit 2 Someone on the phone shows how to deal with incoming phone calls from a range of people. This includes unwanted calls (e.g. marketing cold calls).

Unit 3 Something in the post features some common types of mail that people receive (e.g. a utility bill), and enables learners to understand what the text means, and to know what to do in response.

Level: Entry 2 / Access 3 in Scotland / CEF A2. The materials are designed to be flexible in terms of differentiation, and are accessible to established E2 learners and at the same time relevant to E1, as well as E3 and L1.

Structure, learning hours and delivery context

English in my home provides a minimum of 11 hours of learning in a classroom or self-access context through a series of three linked units. Each unit can be taught as a standalone. Here is an overview of the content of each unit. Each unit has four topics:

Unit 1: Someone at the door (includes films)

- Topic a: Electricity meter reading
- Topic b: Charity collection
- Topic c: Parcel delivery
- Topic d: The neighbour

Unit 2: Someone on the phone (includes films)

- Topic a: Cold call
- Topic b: Wrong number
- **Topic c: An emergency (the focus of this set of resources)**
- Topic d: Getting a plumber

Unit 3: Something in the post

- Topic a: Bank statement
- Topic b: Phone bill
- Topic c: Attempted delivery note
- Topic d: Note from a neighbour

Each of the four topics in *Someone at the door* and *Someone on the phone* features a short film. These films have been scripted specifically for the project, and involve actors. The two central characters are a married Indian couple, who have recently moved to the UK, and who are getting used to life here. Each film focuses on them in a specific scenario, such as dealing with a meter reader who arrives at their flat, or dealing with unwanted cold calls on the telephone. ESOL learners should be able to relate to the experiences of the couple.

The learner materials and teacher notes contain activities for use before, during and after watching the films. They enable the learners to notice, learn and use some of the functional language featured in the films.

Something in the post, uses semi-authentic material of the kinds that learners may receive in their home, and helps them to understand these and know what action is needed.

Most topics provide approximately 60 minutes of classroom time.

Unit 2 Someone on the phone: overview

This unit provides up to 4 hours of classroom time, and covers 4 topics. Each topic features a short film, commissioned by the British Council for the ESOL Nexus project, and filmed with professional actors. The films aim to show real-life situations in which ESOL learners may find themselves, and the accompanying classroom and self-study materials aim to give learners the language they need to deal with a range of household situations.

The topics of *Someone on the phone* are called *A cold call*, *Wrong number*, *An emergency*, and *Getting a plumber*. The first two topics can be used in any order but ideally *An emergency* should be taught before *Getting a plumber*.

An emergency – teacher's notes

Time:

Approximately 60 minutes. Timings are flexible.

Aims

- to enable learners to describe household problems and request action over the phone

Objectives

Learners will be able to:

- understand the gist and detail of the film
- speak using a range of phrases to describe household problems and ask for help
- take part in a role-play dealing with an emergency

Preparation

You will need:

- worksheets (pages 9-11): one copy per learner
- transcript (page 12): one copy per learner
- an internet connection and data projector to play the film

Suggested Procedure

Lead-in

Hand out the **learner worksheet (page 9)** and elicit the missing word that the woman is saying (*emergency*). You could play hangman if learners cannot guess the word. Elicit that the lesson is about emergencies, and more specifically, emergencies in the home.

Elicit other typical household emergencies, e.g. the boiler breaks, somebody loses their keys, the heating doesn't work, there's an electricity cut. Put the learners into pairs, and ask them to find out whether their partners have had any problems like this, and if so what they did and who they contacted.

During feedback, discuss who they need to call if there is a problem, and establish that for many people, the first point of call would be their Housing Association.

Task 1: understanding vocabulary

Tell the learners that they are going to watch a video about an emergency in a home, and that you are going to start by showing them some vocabulary which they need to understand.

Hand out **worksheets (page 10 and 11)** and display Task 1 on the projector if possible.

Ask learners to do Task 1 and compare their answers in pairs. Make sure all learners understand *leak* and *plumber* – you might need to concept-check these items. Elicit possible causes of leaks (bath, shower, radiator, washing machine, dishwasher), and reasons why they are a problem (wet floors are dangerous; water might go down into another flat; you can't use the device that has a leak etc).

Check pronunciation and word stress.

Task 2: using vocabulary

Ask learners to complete Task 2 and encourage them to check their answers in pairs by reading their answers aloud. Elicit feedback and check pronunciation and intonation.

First viewing of the video

Tell the learners that they are now going to watch the film in which a young couple, Sunita and Arjun, have an emergency in their home. Explain that the film contains all the words from Task 1. In pairs, tell learners to use all these words to predict what they think will happen in the film. Play the film and ask them to discuss whether their predictions were right. Elicit whole group feedback where you and the learners compare their predictions with what really happened.

Task 3: understanding the film

Tell learners to read the questions in Task 3. If necessary, read the questions aloud and check understanding.

Play the film again, and then ask learners to discuss the questions in pairs, using the phrases from Task 1 and Task 2. Elicit feedback, and encourage learners to give full answers.

Task 4: describing a problem

Explain that Sunita and Arjun use some useful language to describe the problem to Mr Konik. Encourage learners to work on their own first to put the words in order before checking their answers with their partner. When you elicit feedback, write the sentences on the board, concept-check and drill with a focus on pronunciation and intonation. Then focus on one sentence at a time and erase all the words one by one. When you erase each word, replace it with a line and ask them to say the phrase aloud e.g. *It's urgent* > *It's _* > *It _ _* > *_ _ _*. Tell learners to practise saying the sentences to each other just by looking at the gapped sentences on the board.

Remember that the sentences are quite challenging for learners but really useful, so they need (and will enjoy) plenty of practice.

Task 5: describing a problem

Task 5 is an opportunity to notice the use of the salient language in Task 4. Play the film again for the learners to note down the order in which they hear the phrases from Task 4. (You could conduct the feedback for Tasks 4 and 5 together with stronger groups or if you are pushed for time.)

Differentiation – As the ordering task is quite challenging, you may set a similar but simpler task to some of your learners, by asking *Which of the phrases in Task 4 do both Arjun and Sunita say?* (Answer – a and c)

Task 6: role-play

Put the learners into groups of 3. Give each learner a copy of the **transcript** (page 12), ask them to decide who will play which role and then to practise reading the dialogue aloud. Monitor, and help with pronunciation and intonation.

In groups, then ask the learners to write and act out a situation involving a phone call to the Housing Association (or landlord) about another household emergency (e.g. broken boiler, leaking roof, kitchen fire etc). Encourage them to adapt some of the phrases from Task 4, such as:

Something's wrong with the (boiler / heating...)

We've got a big problem in the ... (bathroom / garden...)

There's ... all over the ... (smoke all over the kitchen...)

Could you send someone to... (look at it / mend it) please?

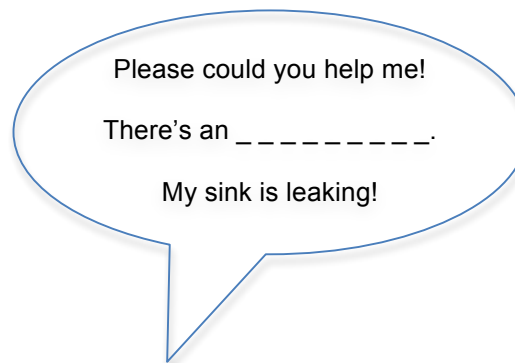
Extension

Ask the learners if they have any problems in their flat (e.g. something that doesn't work, or something that leaks). Establish who they need to contact, then help them prepare for a phone call to this person to get the problem sorted out. Role-play the phone conversation with the learners.

Refer students to the online versions of these ESOL Nexus activities about *An emergency*:
<http://esol.britishcouncil.org/english-my-home/someone-phone-emergency>

Learner worksheet

- Look at the picture below.
- The lady is making a telephone call to ask for help about a problem in her house.
- What is the missing word?



Someone on the phone – An emergency – Teacher's pack

Task 1: understanding vocabulary

Match the words to the pictures.

washing machine	phone	mop	bucket	leak	plumber	boots
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phone



Task 2: using vocabulary

Complete the sentences with a word from the box in Task 1.

I put all the dirty clothes in the (1).....

Can I use the (2).....? I need to make a call.

I wash my kitchen floor with a (3)..... of water and a (4).....

I'm going out, but it's raining, so I'm going to wear my (5).....

When I have a problem with my toilet I call a (6)..... He's very good.

There's a (7)..... in my roof, and water's going all over my bedroom floor.

Task 3: understanding the film

1. Why does Sunita say 'Oh no!'?
2. What does Arjun give her? Why?
3. Who phones Sunita and Arjun? Why?
4. Why does Sunita say 'That's not fine'?
5. Why does Arjun say 'My wife's wearing boots in the kitchen?'?
6. What does 'ASAP' mean?



Sunita with a bucket and mop (left). Arjun (right)

Task 4: describing a problem

Put the words in order.

a.	urgent It 's	<i>It's urgent</i>
b.	It broken. 's	
c.	There's the floor. water all over	
d.	got We've in kitchen. a problem the big	
e.	's It leaking	
f.	someone We need now.	
g.	's It emergency. an	
h.	Next no good. week is	
i.	wrong with the Something 's washing machine.	
j.	send Could you someone to please? fix it	

Task 5: describing a problem

Watch the film again. What order do you hear sentences a-j?

- | | | | |
|------|----|----|----|
| 1. i | 3. | 5. | 7. |
| 2. | 4. | 6. | 8. |

Task 6: role-play

Work in pairs and practise role-play phone calls to talk about other household problems.

Someone on the phone – An emergency – Teacher's pack

Transcript

Wife Oh no! Arjun! Something's wrong with the washing machine. It's leaking!

Husband Oh! Well, the floor was dirty. The water will clean it.

Wife There's water all over the floor.

Husband *(He gives her a pair of boots.)* These will keep your feet dry.

Wife Ugh! I'm phoning the housing association.

Mr Konik Thank you for calling Giston Housing Association. Please leave a message.

Wife Hello, this is Sunita Chowdry. I live in Bewick Court, in flat 30. We've got a big problem in the kitchen. Please could you phone me back? It's urgent, so please call me back soon. My number is 020 7442 3204. Thank you. Bye.

(The phone rings. The wife is mopping the floor.)

Husband I have to do everything in this house! Hello?

Mr Konik Hello, am I speaking with Mr Chowdry please?

Husband Speaking.

Mr Konik Hello. This is Mr Konik from Giston Housing Association.

Husband Ah, thank you for calling back.

Mr Konik Your wife left a message about a problem in the kitchen. What's wrong?

Husband It's the washing machine. It's broken.

Mr Konik I see.

Husband Could you send someone to fix it please?

Mr Konik OK. I'll contact a plumber. But it'll probably be next week.

Husband That's fine. Next week.

Wife No, that's *not* fine! We need someone now!

Husband Actually, next week is no good. It's urgent. There's water all over the floor. My wife's wearing boots in the kitchen.

Mr Konik I see.

Husband It's an emergency.

Mr Konik Right, I see. Well, I'll try and get you a plumber ASAP.

Husband I'm sorry?

Mr Konik As soon as possible. I'll contact the plumber now. I'll tell him that it's an emergency. And I'll ask him to contact you.

Husband That's great. I'll wait for his call... ASAP.

Mr Konik Thanks then. Bye.

Husband Bye..... *(He hangs up.)* You see? The boots were a good idea!

Answers**Task 2: using vocabulary**

1. washing machine
2. phone
3. bucket
4. mop
5. boots
6. plumber
7. leak

Task 3: understanding the film

1. Because the washing machine is leaking
2. He gives her boots because the floor is wet.
3. Mr Konik (from Giston Housing Association). He phones about the leaking washing machine.
4. She wants the plumber now, not next week.
5. He wants to persuade Mr Konik to send the plumber now, not next week.
6. As soon as possible

Task 4: describing a problem

- a. It's urgent
- b. It's broken.
- c. There's water all over the floor.
- d. We've got a big problem in the kitchen.
- e. It's leaking.
- f. We need someone now.
- g. It's an emergency.
- h. Next week is no good.
- i. Something's wrong with the washing machine.
- j. Could you send someone to fix it please?

Task 5: describing a problem

1. i
2. e
3. c
4. d
5. a
6. b
7. j
8. f
9. h (then a and c again)
10. g

Someone on the phone – 'An emergency' video

The video that accompanies the activities for Unit 2 'Someone on the phone – An emergency' is available to watch on the ESOL Nexus website.

